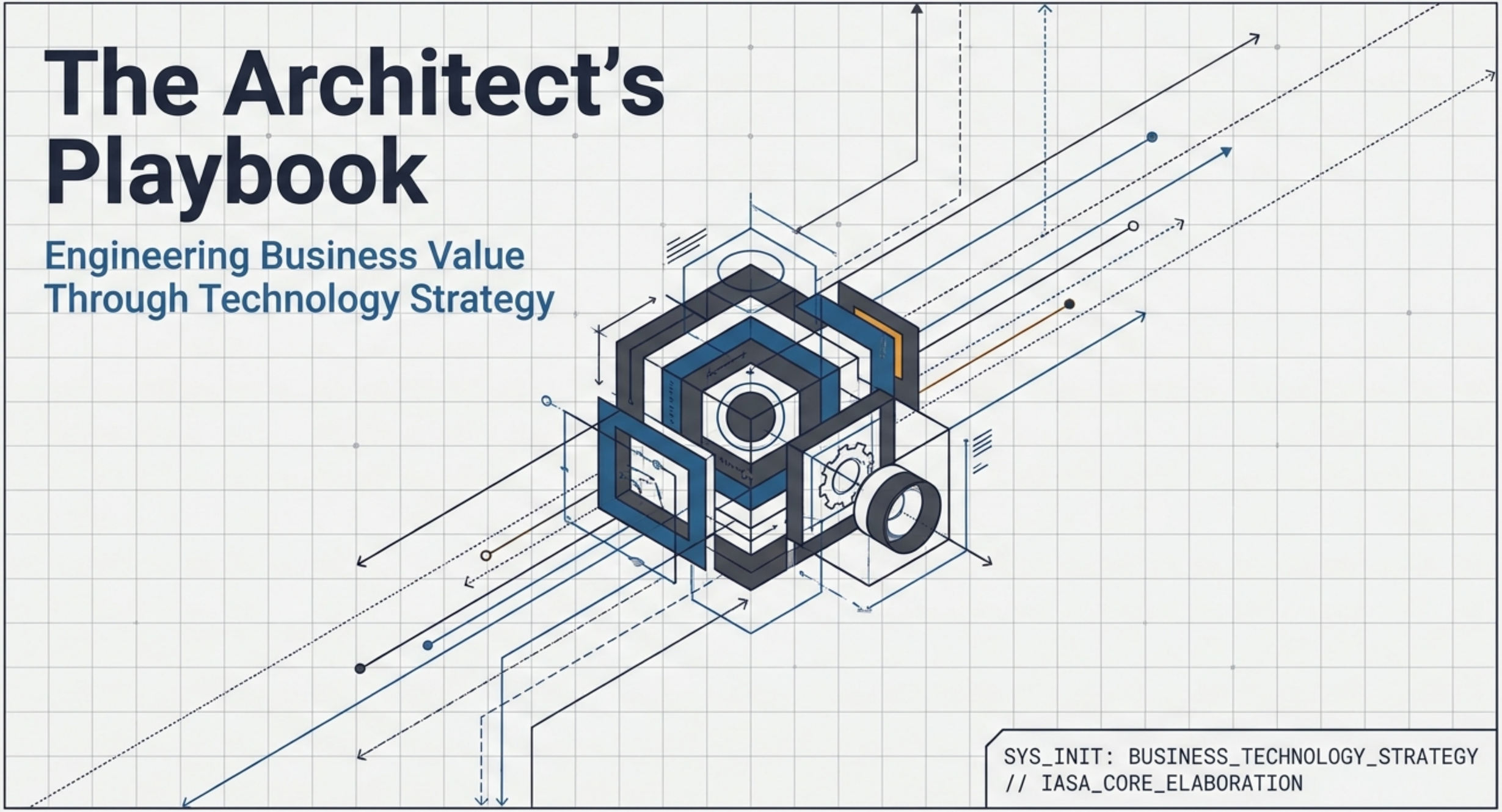
The Architect's Playbook

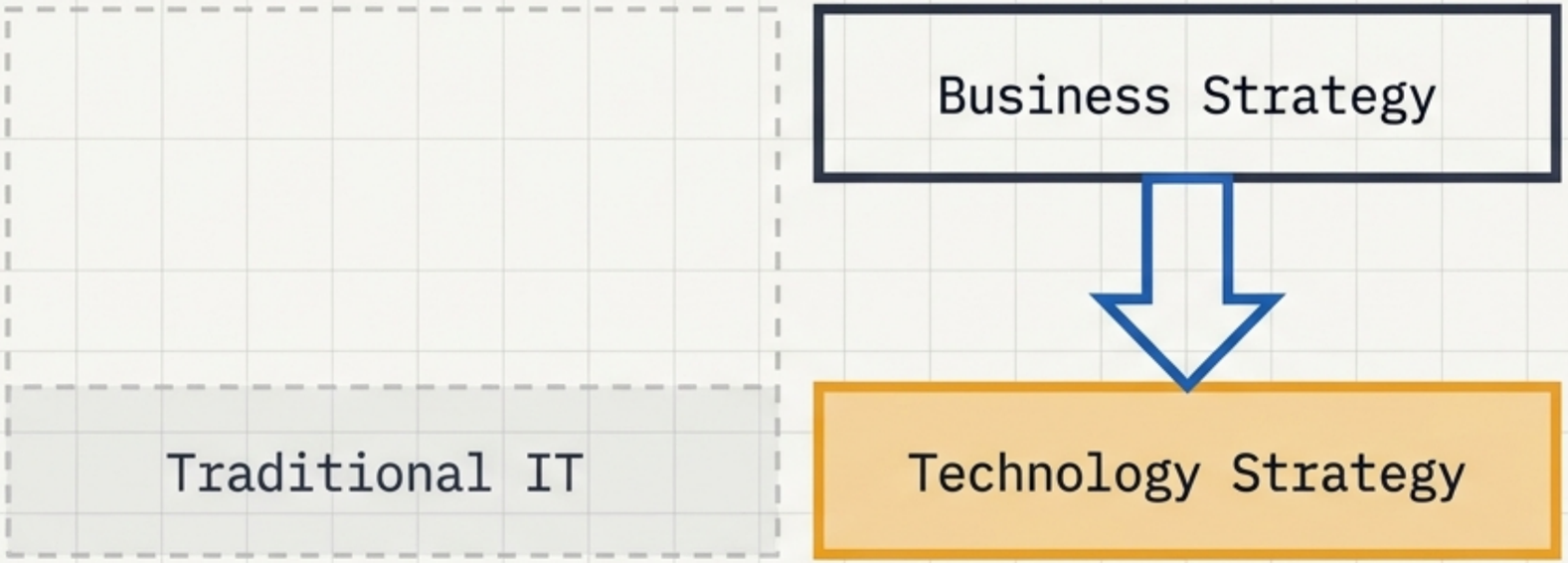
Engineering Business Value Through Technology Strategy



SYS_INIT: BUSINESS_TECHNOLOGY_STRATEGY
// IASA_CORE_ELABORATION

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SYSTEM CONTEXT > STRATEGIC MANDATE



Functional Distinctions

- Do not confuse Strategy with:
  - IT Operations (Run)
  - Project Delivery (Change)
  - Enterprise Architecture (Structure)

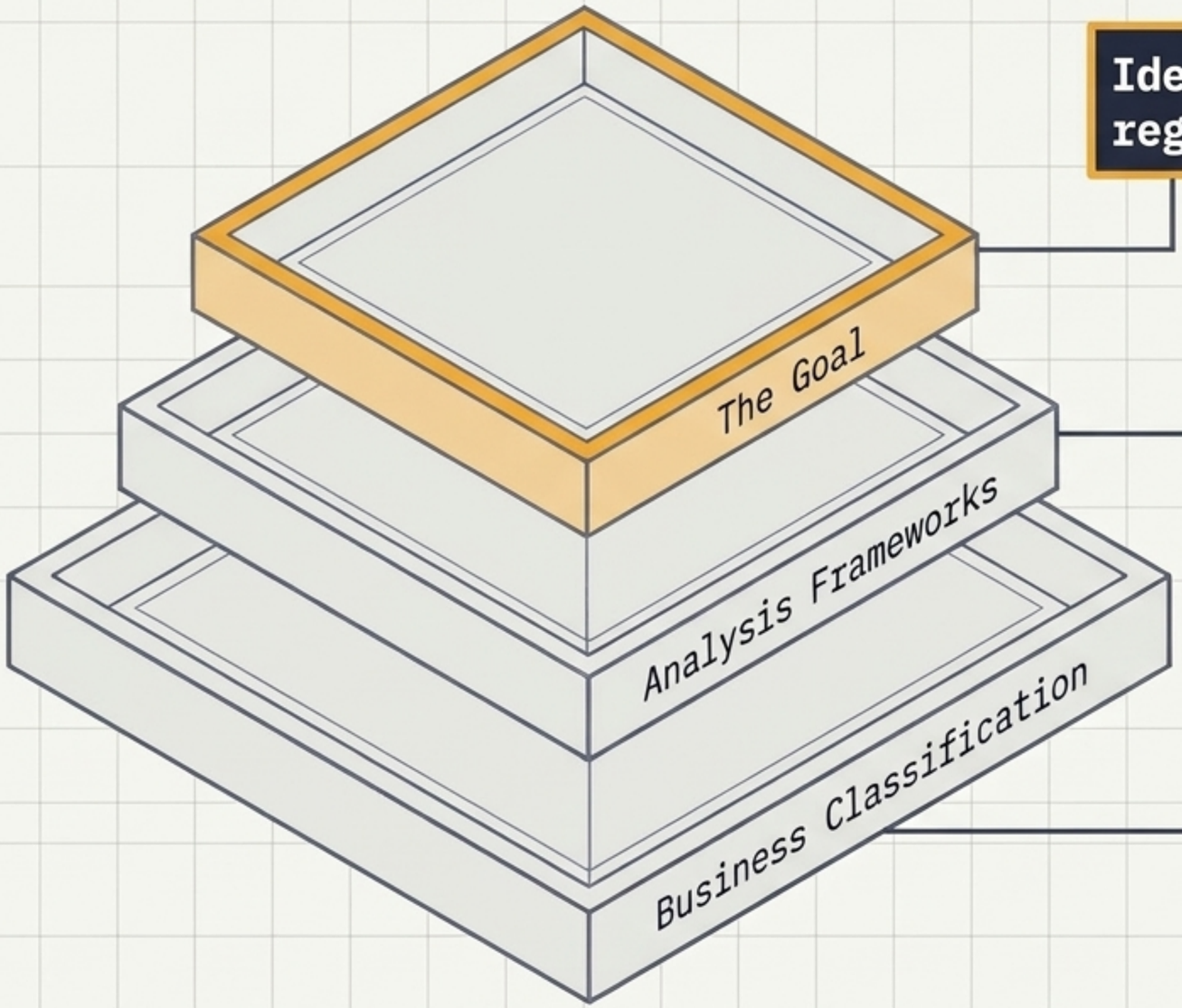
The Mandate:

Technology strategy is a plan describing how technology will enable and differentiate the business strategy. Business strategy drives technology strategy.

CORE COMPONENTS: Vision | Principles | Capability Roadmap | Target Architecture | Governance | Sourcing

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SYSTEM CONTEXT > BUSINESS FUNDAMENTALS



Identify trends (AI, open banking, regulation) shaping technology demand.

Industry Forces: Porter's Five Forces.

Macro Environment: PESTLE.

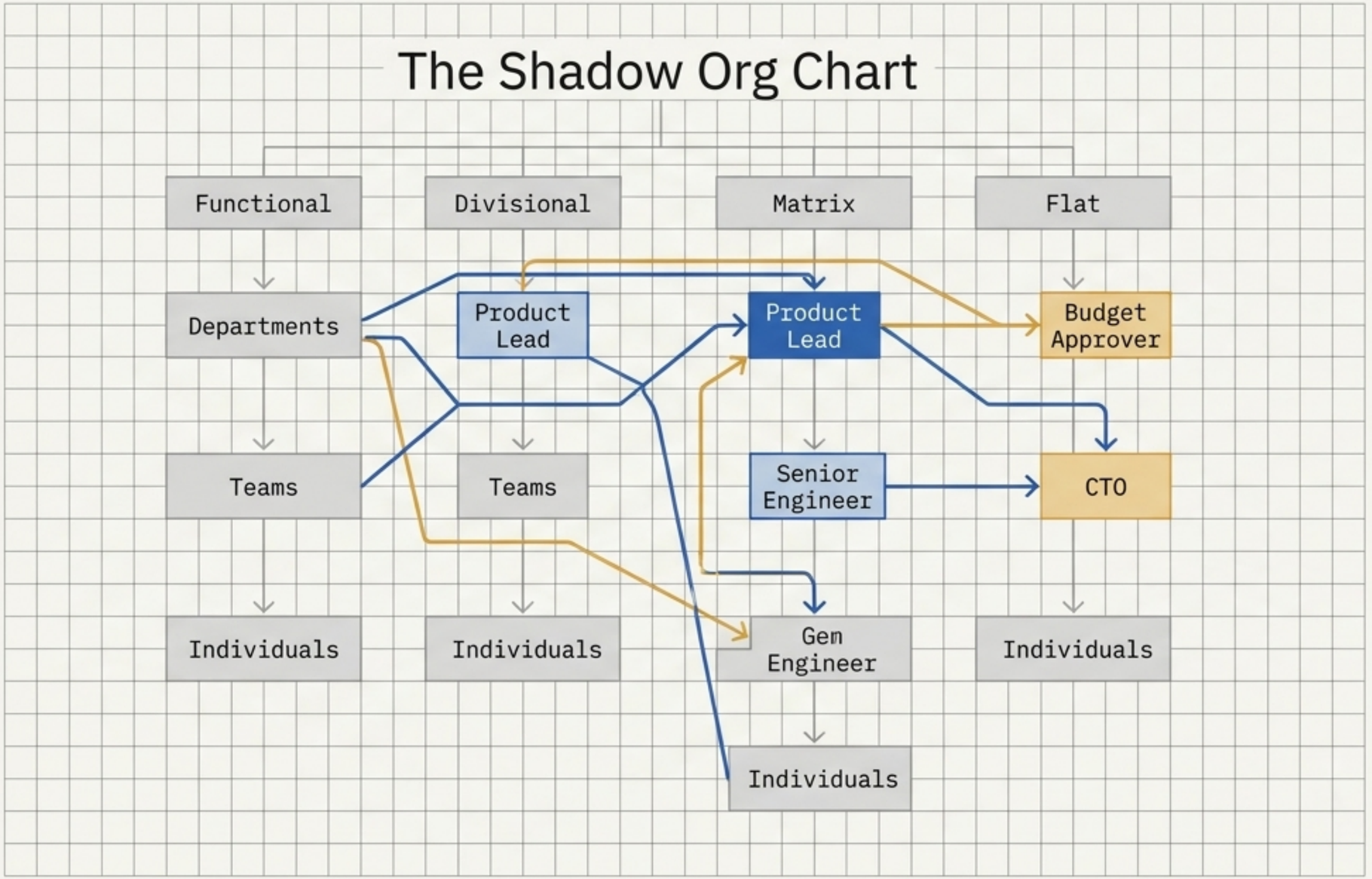
Internal Assessment: SWOT & Value Chain Analysis.

Model: Product, Service, Platform/Market, Subscription, Franchise, Non-Profit/Gov.

Segment: B2B, B2C, B2G, Vertical.

Architectural Impact: Determines system priorities (e.g., Banking = Compliance; Retail = CX; Startup = Speed).

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Formal Alignment

Map where IT sits: centralized, federated, or embedded in business units.

Influence Topology

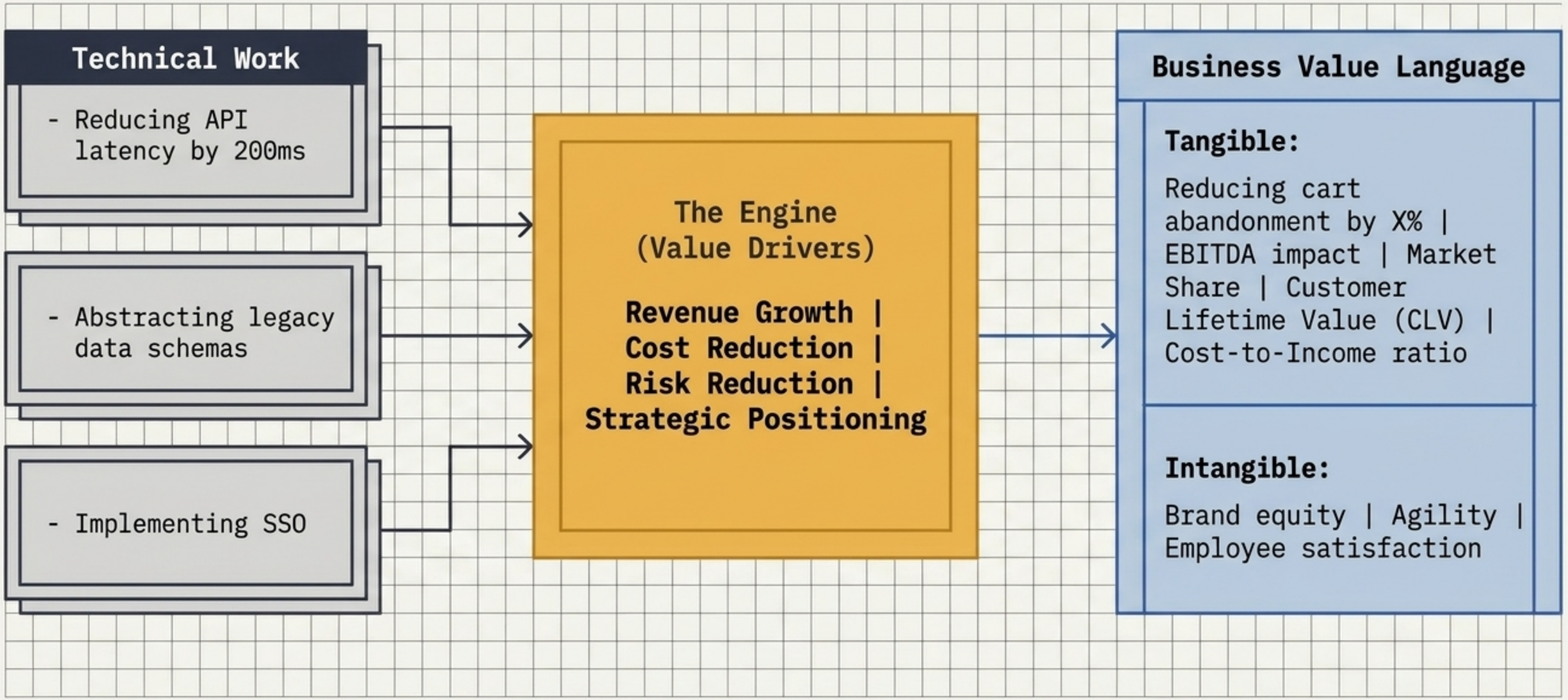
Identify informal decision-makers and actual budget owners.

Strategic Purpose

Use this map to know exactly whom to engage, where political friction sits, and how architectural changes will ripple through the enterprise.

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VALUE INTERFACE > THE TRANSLATION ENGINE



Value translation is the critical skill of the strategist. Never pitch a technical metric without its business o

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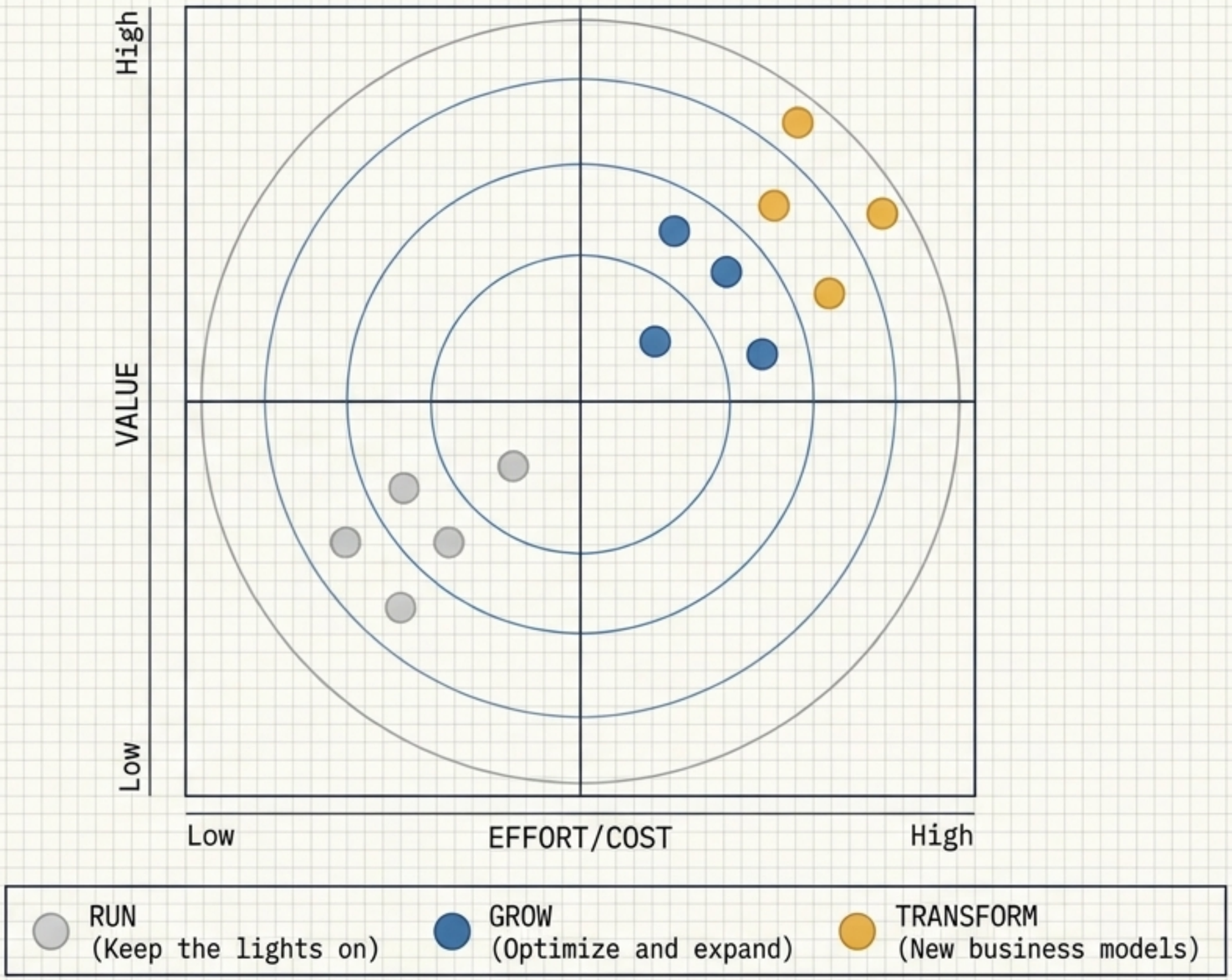
VALUE INTERFACE > TECHNOLOGY VALUATION DIAGNOSTIC

Technology as a Cost Center	Technology as an Enabler	Technology as a Differentiator
Focus: Efficiency	**Focus:** Capability	**Focus:** Competitive Advantage
Valuation Method: TCO (Total Cost of Ownership), Payback Period.	**Valuation Method:** ROI (Return on Investment), NPV.	**Valuation Method:** Real-Options thinking for uncertain, high-reward investments.

WARNING: Always calculate hidden costs (technical debt, maintenance, integration) and the cost of inaction (security exposure, obsolescence, lost market share).

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VALUE INTERFACE > INVESTMENT PORTFOLIO RADAR



EXECUTION CHECKLIST

1. Collect demand portfolio.
2. Score against agreed criteria (strategic alignment, risk, urgency, dependencies) before scoring begins to remove politics.
3. Build the business case: Problem, options, costs, benefits, KPIs.
4. Plan benefits realization (assign ownership for post-delivery measurement).

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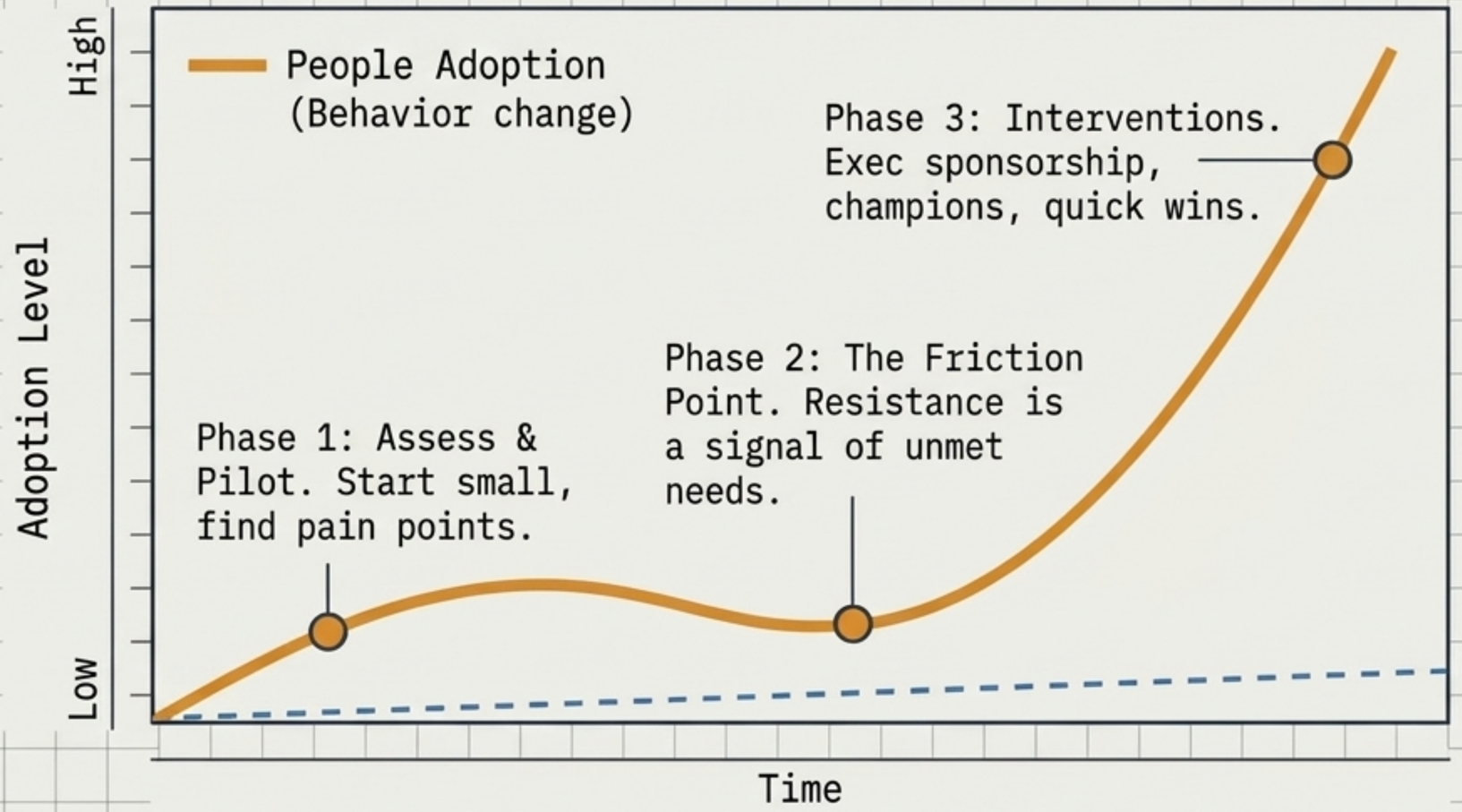
GOVERNANCE PROTOCOLS > FRAMEWORK ECOSYSTEM MATRIX

FRAMEWORKS	SCOPE	PRESCRIPTIVENESS	COST TO ADOPT	CULTURAL FIT
Enterprise Architecture: TOGAF, Zachman, FEAF				
Governance & Management: COBIT, ITIL, ISO 38500				
Delivery: Agile, SAFe, Waterfall, DevOps				
Analysis & Process: BABOK, BPMN				

SYNTHESIS: No single framework is complete. Tailor and combine based on organizational maturity and size. A framework adopted for its own sake without visible, rapid value will be rejected.

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GOVERNANCE PROTOCOLS > THE ADOPTION CURVE



MEASUREMENT METRICS

- Leading: Training completion, standard compliance.

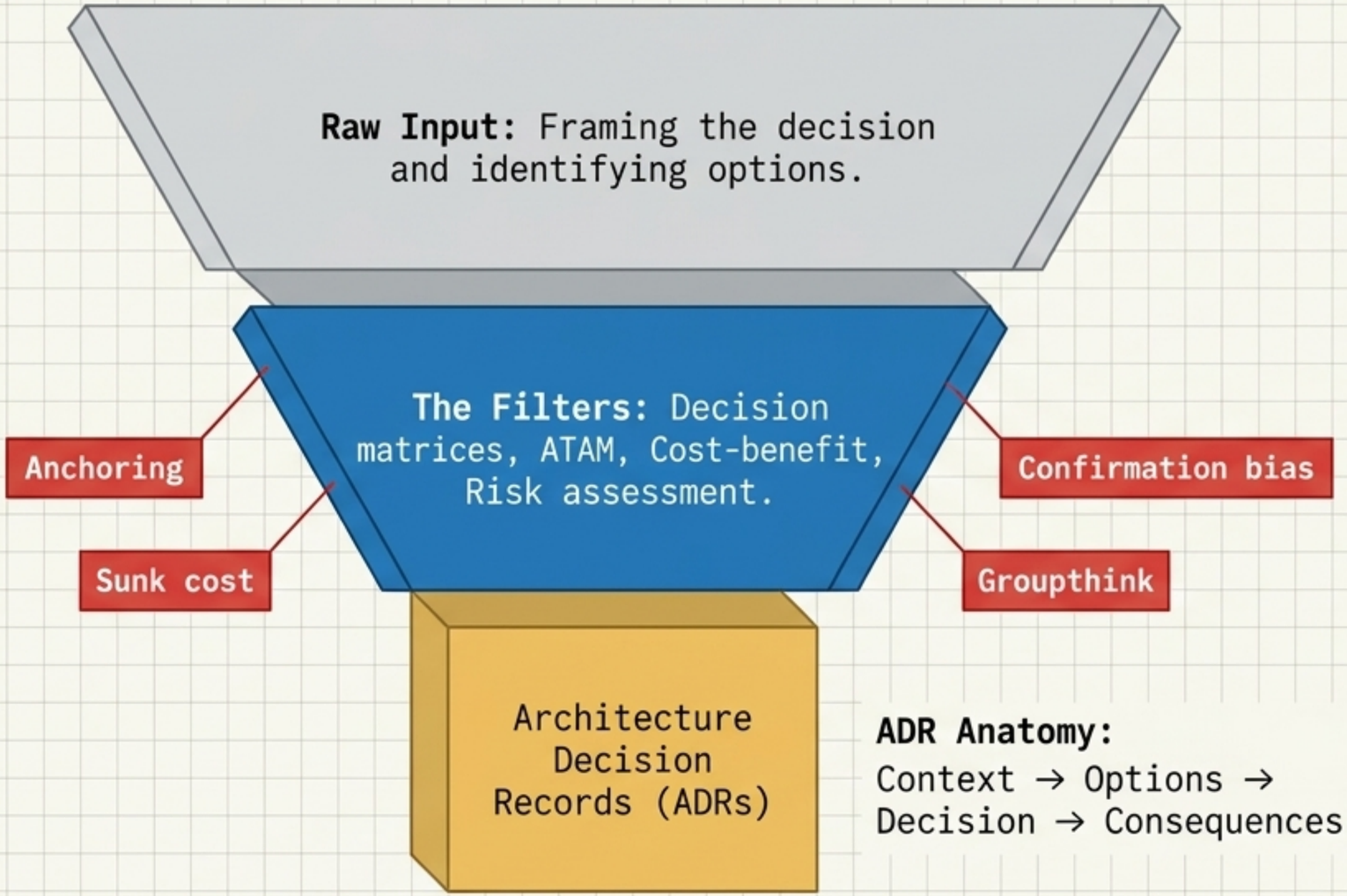
- Lagging: Project outcomes, reduced rework, delivery speed.

PROCESS RULE: For BPM, always improve the process before automating it. Automating inefficiency scales waste.

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PROCESSING ENGINE > DECISION WORKFLOW & KNOWLEDGE

Decision Funnel



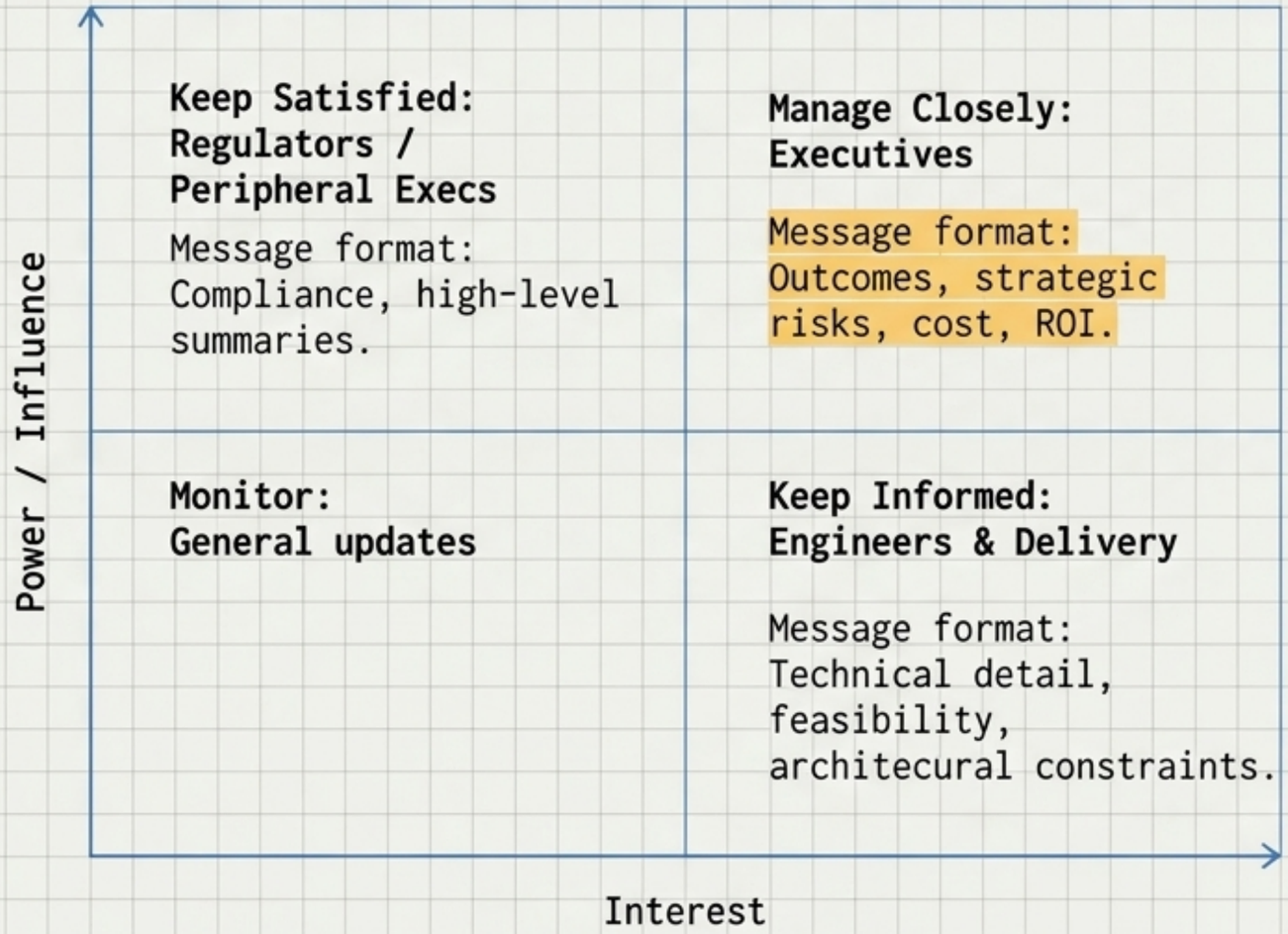
ADR Anatomy:
Context → Options → Decision → Consequences.

Knowledge Management Rules

- Capture tacit and explicit knowledge.
- Use repositories, wikis, and decision logs.
- Make it part of the workflow—if it's extra work, it won't get done.
- Decide at the last responsible moment.

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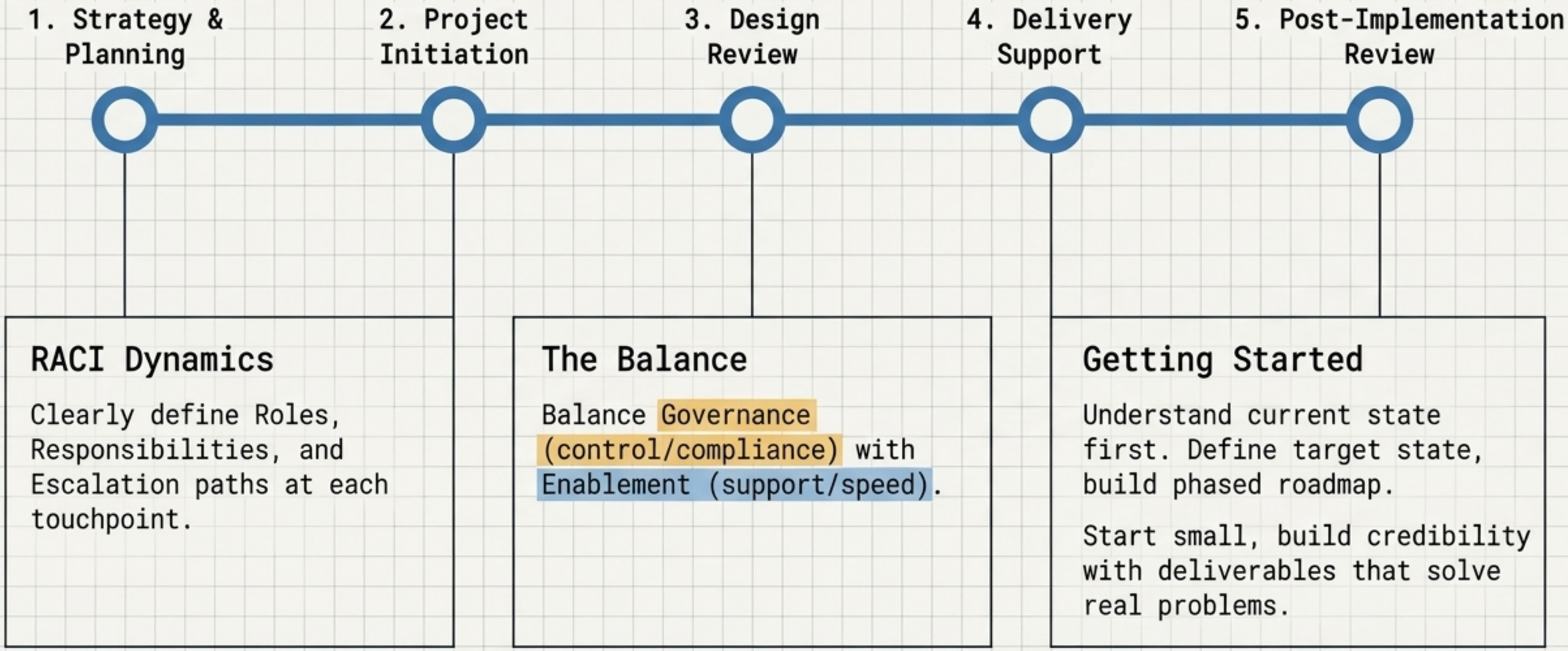
EXECUTION LAYER > STAKEHOLDER COMMUNICATION GRID



The Communication Plan (Checklist)
- Define channel, frequency, owner, and feedback loops. - Always use a consistent story: The "Why," the "What," and the "What it means for you."

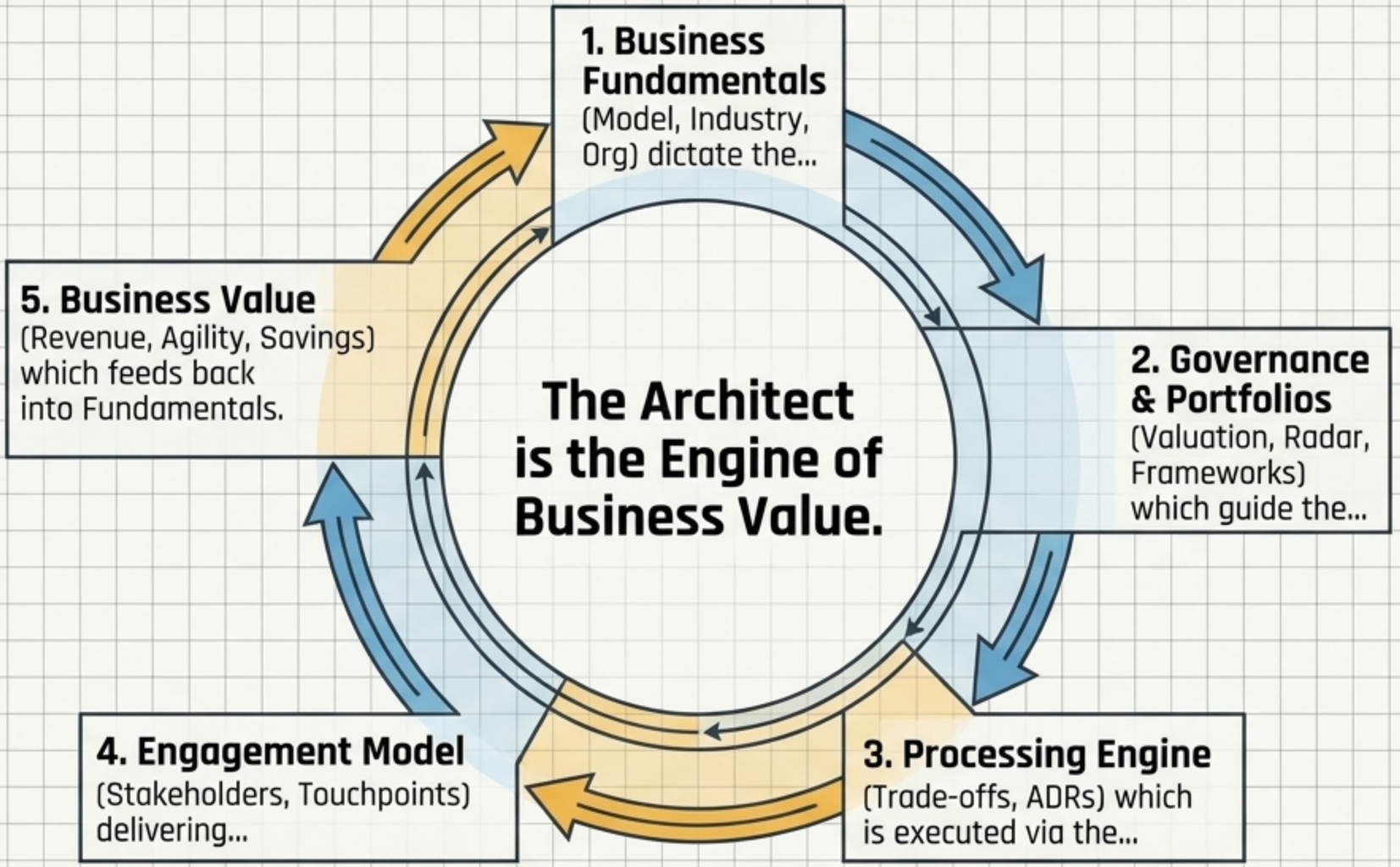
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EXECUTION LAYER > THE ENGAGEMENT MODEL



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SYSTEM INTEGRATION > THE OPERATING MODEL



Technology is only successful when it measurably enables the business.
Manage knowledge, decide with rigor, communicate relentlessly.

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